

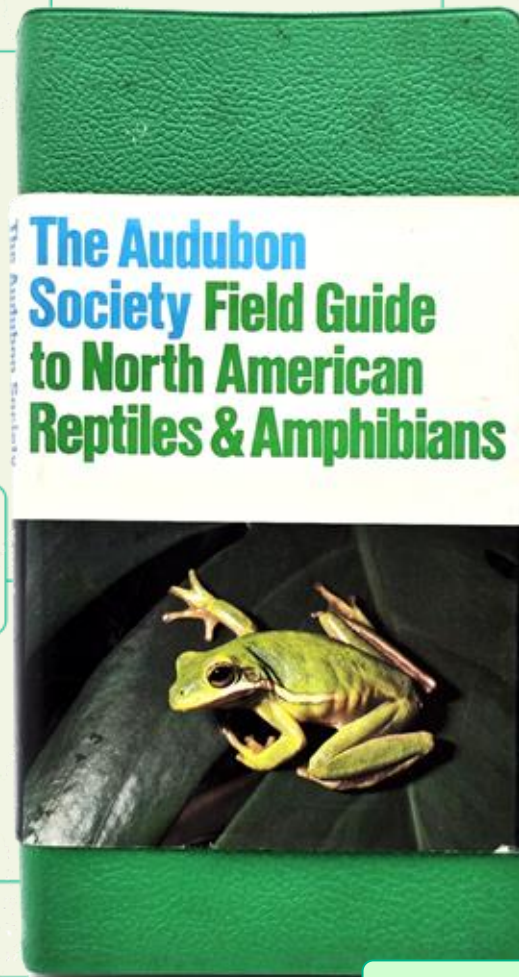


**FY26 Company Connect
Lightning Talks:**

Invoca Field Guide to Problem Statements



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Director of User Experience



2025 08 07

Agenda

- Characteristics of a good problem statement
- Common types that are lacking
- Walk up the ladder
- Why go to all this trouble?
- Upshot



What makes a good problem statement?

- Factual
- Specific
- Real
- Open
- Witnessable



Some problematic problem statement types

- Customer lacks insight into {topic}
- Invoca lacks {capability}
- {Feature} lacks {capability}
- As a customer I would be helped if I could {activity}
- I want to gain value via {activity}
- I want to gain {value} via {activity}
- Invoca features are focused on {topic} and not {other topic}
- Just put a {button} {here} that does {thing}, I'm 100% sure that is what is needed and have a ton of experience working with customers that

- **Factual:** based on actual customer knowledge
- **Specific:** we can name
 - examples of the customer who has this problem
 - the pain caused by the problem
 - bonus: things these customers do to try to alleviate the pain
- **Real:**
 - a real person feels this real problem in their real life
 - the pain is real
- **Open:** the solution is not embedded in the statement – the team has flexibility to address the problem
- **Witnessable:** if the problem statement were alleviated, you could readily tell based on customer behavior or results

More common problems with problem statements

- Long
- Problems + solutions + wishes
- About scope
- Elastic user
- A story
- A single, narrow solution

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NO GLYPH

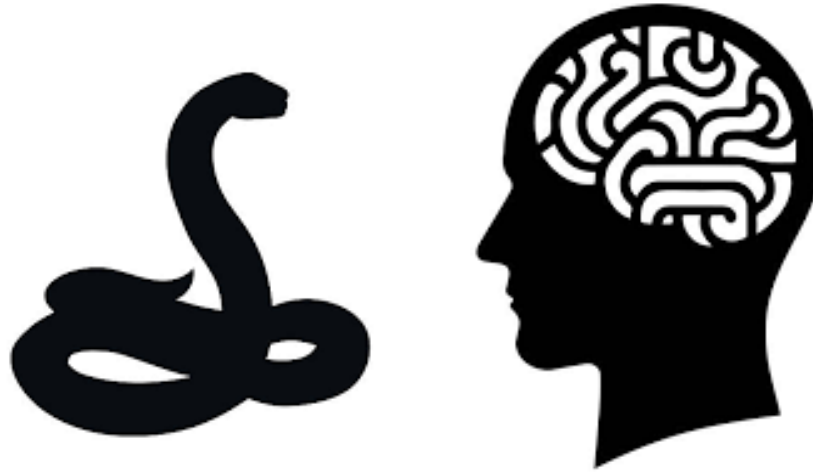
Problem statement

People lack insight into how certain animals may be dangerous



Problem statement

People don't understand snakes



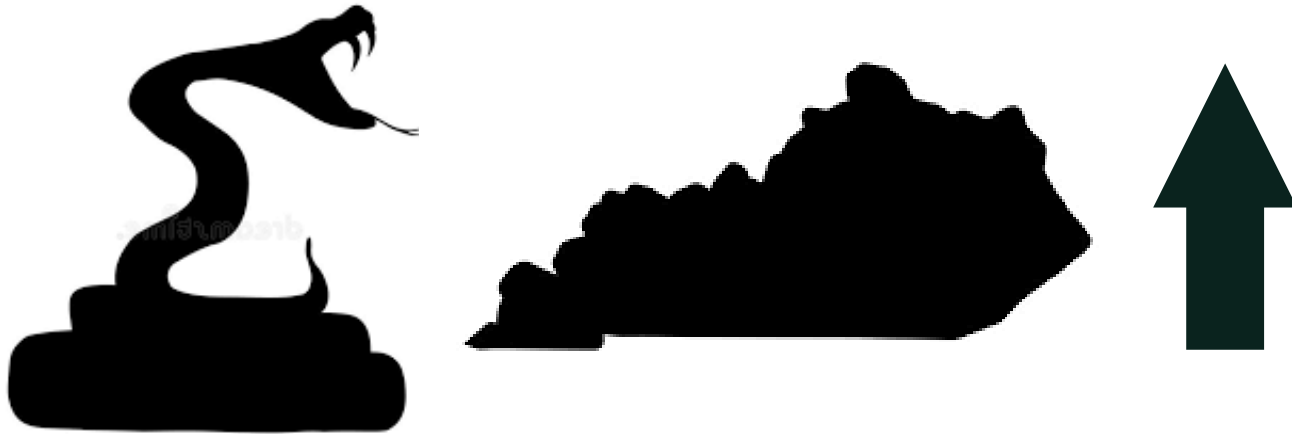
Problem statement

People need help avoiding and treating snakebite



Problem statement

People in Kentucky are getting bitten a lot more than folks elsewhere and than they used to



Problem statement

Hikers in the wetlands of Western Kentucky are being bitten by the Western Cottonmouth at an increasing rate, and often do not survive to be evacuated given their remote location

The Western Cottonmouth is a stout snake with a thick, muscular body. It is the smallest of the three subspecies of *A. piscivorus*. The average length of mature specimens is 27.5 inches (69.9 cm), while the maximum reported length is 62 inches (157.5 cm).

Adult specimens are usually dark gray or brown with little or no markings, although a dorsal color pattern consisting of 10 to 15 dark crossbands can be seen in some specimens. Like other members of the species, its color darkens with age, and very old specimens may appear entirely black. Unlike the other two subspecies, the light line that borders the dark cheek strip is usually not present in this subspecies. The dorsal scales are keeled, in rows of 25 near the midbody, and the anal scale is undivided. Its broad, flat head is distinctly wider than its neck, and it has an elliptical (cat-like) pupil. By day the pupil appears as a narrow slit; at night the pupil is wide and may even look round.



Agkistrodon piscivorus leucostoma ♀



Problem statements

- People lack insight into how certain animals may be dangerous
- People don't understand snakes
- People need help avoiding and treating snakebite
- People in Kentucky are getting bitten a lot more than folks elsewhere, and than they used to
- Hikers in the wetlands of Western Kentucky are being bitten by the Western Cottonmouth at an increasing rate, and often do not survive to be evacuated given their remote location

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A good problem statement helps...

- Where to look
- Understand why
- Know if it's working
- Measure
- Compare projects
- Preserve flexibility
- Evaluate concepts

Not grammatically perfect parallel structure, sorry, you get it

Hikers in the wetlands of Western Kentucky are being bitten by the Western Cottonmouth at an increasing rate, and often do not survive to be evacuated given their remote location

Concepts

- ~~Footwear modification to protect the ankles~~
- ~~Services changes to evacuate snakebite victims more readily~~
- Improved antivenom
- ~~Reduction of the Western Cottonmouth population~~
- Distribution of treatment kits appropriate to this sort of bite
- Maps that show where the Western Cottonmouth is prevalent
- Warning signs at trails

- ~~Re-routing of trails to avoid areas where bites are most frequent~~
- Education about how to identify and avoid the Western Cottonmouth when hiking in the wetlands of Western Kentucky
- Education about how to treat snakebite

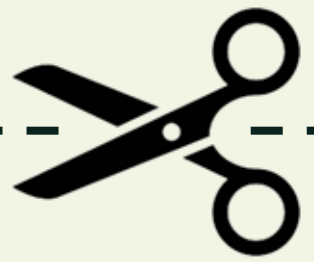
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**If we don't have
multiple ideas
we can't choose
the best one.**

Measurement possibilities

- Incidence of snakebite ↓
- Snakebite fatalities ↓
- Fatalities avoided via evacuation ↑
- Self-treatment efficacy ↑

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Problem statement memory jogger

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Thanks!

What questions
do you have?

